

Reading

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The Girl Who Didn't Stop

Before you read

- Look at the title. What do you think 'didn't stop' might mean here?
- Have you ever heard a true story about someone who overcame a difficult childhood?

Elif grew up in a small town where her family didn't have much money. Her father worked long hours at a local workshop, and her mother sold vegetables at the market. When Elif was ten years old, her father lost his job, and things became even harder. The family moved into a smaller house, and Elif started helping her mother at the market every morning before school.

While her classmates were playing after school, Elif was usually working or studying by candlelight, because the electricity at home was often cut off. She used to dream about becoming a teacher one day, but nobody in her family had ever finished university. Many people told her it wasn't realistic for a girl from her background.

Elif didn't listen to them. She studied every night, even when she was exhausted, and she never missed a day of school. One teacher noticed how determined she was and began giving her extra books to read. Slowly, Elif's grades improved, and after years of hard work, she won a scholarship to study education at a university in another city.

Today, Elif is a teacher at a school not far from the town where she grew up. She often tells her students that hard times don't have to decide who you become. 'I used to think poverty would stop me,' she says, 'but it actually taught me how to keep going.' Her story has since inspired several of her own students to keep studying, no matter how difficult their situation is.

1. What was the main obstacle in Elif's early life?
 - a. She was ill for many years.
 - b. Her family had very little money.
 - c. She didn't like school.
 - d. She lived far from her family.
2. Elif used to help her mother at the _____ every morning.
3. Elif's family had electricity all the time. — *True / False*
4. What helped Elif improve her grades?
 - a. Moving to a bigger house
 - b. Her father's new job
 - c. A teacher who gave her extra books
 - d. Stopping work at the market
5. Elif won a _____ to study education at university.

6. According to Elif, what did poverty actually teach her?

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- a. To give up early
- b. How to keep going
- c. To avoid school
- d. To depend on others

After you read

- Do you agree that hard times can teach us something useful? Why or why not?
- What would you say to a friend who feels like giving up during a difficult time?

From the Repair Shop to the Stage

Before you read

- What jobs do you know that require working with your hands?
- Do you think it's possible to follow a dream while working a difficult job?

Kerem's father used to run a small bicycle repair shop, and Kerem started helping him there when he was only eleven. While other children in the neighbourhood were going to after-school clubs, Kerem was fixing tyres and cleaning chains. The family needed the extra income, so there wasn't much time left for hobbies.

One rainy afternoon, while Kerem was repairing an old guitar that a customer had left behind, he started playing a few notes just to test the strings. He had never had lessons, but something about the sound stayed with him. From that day, whenever the shop was quiet, he practised on that same guitar, teaching himself simple songs from an old book his uncle had given him.

Life didn't get easier quickly. Kerem still worked at the shop every afternoon, and money was often tight at home. But he used to save a little money from small jobs to buy guitar strings, and he never stopped practising, even during the hardest months when the shop had almost no customers.

Years later, a local café owner heard Kerem playing outside the repair shop and asked him to perform one evening. That first small concert led to others, and slowly Kerem built a name for himself as a musician in his city. He still visits the repair shop sometimes, not to fix bicycles, but to remind himself where his journey began.

1. What was Kerem's family business?

- a. A music shop
- b. A bicycle repair shop
- c. A café
- d. A bookshop

2. Kerem first started playing an old _____ that a customer had left.

3. Kerem had professional guitar lessons from the start. — True / False

4. How did Kerem get his first chance to perform?

- a. He entered a competition.
- b. A café owner heard him playing outside the shop.
- c. His uncle organised a concert.
- d. He advertised online.

5. Kerem used to save money from small jobs to buy guitar _____.

After you read

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- What does this story suggest about combining work and following a passion?
- Do you know someone who kept a hobby going during a difficult time? Tell your partner about it.